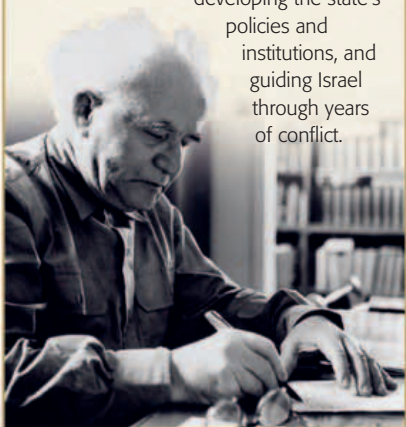


ISRAELI STATESMAN (1886–1973)

DAVID BEN-GURION

David Ben-Gurion was born in Poland. He moved to Palestine in 1906 and became a prominent member of the Zionist movement, leading the struggle to establish a state of Israel. Ben-Gurion became Israel's first prime minister in 1949. Until his retirement in 1970, he played a major role in Israeli life,

developing the state's policies and institutions, and guiding Israel through years of conflict.



Despite this, Britain withdrew and on May 14, 1948 the Jewish state of Israel was established. It was recognized by the US, the Soviet Union, and other UN members, but not neighboring Arab countries, which refused to accept Israel as a state.

Troubles in the homeland

One of the first tasks for Israel's new leader, David Ben-Gurion, was to create the Israeli Defense Force from the Hagannah and other Jewish paramilitary organizations. Israel had real and immediate needs to defend itself as, once it was established, the country was invaded by Egypt, Syria, Transjordan (later Jordan), Lebanon, and Iraq, beginning the Arab–Israeli War of 1947–49, the first in a series of conflicts between Israel and the Arab world (see AFTER). A further threat to security was the Palestine Liberation



Evacuation of Jerusalem
This man was among thousands of Jews who were evacuated from Jerusalem by British troops in 1948. The city had come under siege from Arab militias who, in reaction to the Partition Plan, tried to dispossess the 100,000 Jewish people living in the city.

Organization (PLO). Formed in 1964 when various Arab guerrilla groups and political factions joined together, the PLO's stated aim was the destruction of Israel through armed struggle. The PLO sponsored innumerable guerrilla raids on Israeli civilian and military targets, giving the organization a worldwide reputation as a terrorist group. In the 1980s, Yasser Arafat, chairman of the PLO since 1969, took on the role of statesman and used diplomacy to achieve the group's ends. However, some Palestinian extremists believed Arafat gave too many concessions to the Israelis during diplomatic talks.



Entry visa

Dated January 1939, this visa allowed the German Jewish holder to emigrate to the British Protectorate of Palestine. By November of the same year restrictions had been placed on the numbers of Jews allowed to settle in the region.



Despite intervention by the international community, tensions between Middle Eastern Arabs and Jews erupted into conflict periodically after Israel was established.

SECOND ARAB–ISRAELI WAR

In 1956 **Egypt nationalized the Suez Canal Company** << 412–13, taking the waterway out of French and British control. Since tensions were also growing between Israel and Egypt over the Egyptian-held Gaza Strip, which Israel believed was a base for guerrilla activity, **Israel, Britain, and France joined forces** to invade Egypt.

SIX-DAY WAR

In response to the massing of Arab forces on its borders, **Israel launched a preemptive strike against Egypt, Jordan, and Syria** in June 1967. After six days, all the parties agreed to a ceasefire, under which Israel gained control of the Gaza Strip, a large part of the Sinai Peninsula, the West Bank, and the Golan Heights, collectively known as **“occupied territories.”**

YOM KIPPUR WAR

In 1973 **Egypt and Syria launched a surprise attack** on Israel on Yom Kippur, the Jewish Day of Atonement, a day on which they knew the Israeli military would be participating in religious celebrations. The Arab forces made significant advances before Israel rallied and pushed the invaders back beyond the 1967 ceasefire lines.

MOVES TOWARD PEACE

In 1978 President Anwar Sadat of Egypt, Prime Minister Menachem Begin of Israel, and President Jimmy Carter of the US signed the Camp David Accords. The accords established a **“Framework for Peace”** in the Middle East, leading to the Israel/Egypt Peace Treaty in 1979.

ISRAELI OCCUPATION OF LEBANON

In an attempt to curtail cross-border attacks by the PLO based in Lebanon, Israel invaded in 1978 and in 1982; they became an occupying force there until 2000. In response to the killing of three Israeli soldiers and the capture of two others by **Hezbollah**, a Lebanese Islamic paramilitary group, Israel reinvaded in 2006.

OSLO ACCORDS

The Intifada (a Palestinian uprising against Israeli rule) persuaded Israel to join talks. The Oslo Accords agreed that Israel would withdraw from parts of **the West Bank and Gaza Strip**, allowing an interim Palestinian government in those areas. Subsequent peace efforts failed and opinions on both sides hardened. Islamist groups such as Hamas and Islamic Jihad gained ground in areas ruled by Palestine, while Israeli hardliners pushed through a policy of isolating these areas by building a **“peace wall.”**



RABIN, CLINTON, AND ARAFAT